CAIS user guide

CAIS is the Centralized Assistance Information System. A department uses it to record who asked for help, what they asked for, and what was actually released.

The steps for each job are in the user manual.

Two groups use it.

- **Applicants** open a public page. They do not need an account.
- **Staff** sign in and work inside their own department.

The home page sends staff to the sign-in screen. Applicants use **Apply** and **Track**.

How a request moves

A request starts as a draft or as a submitted application. Staff then move it through the department workflow until it is released, denied, or closed.

The default pipeline is:

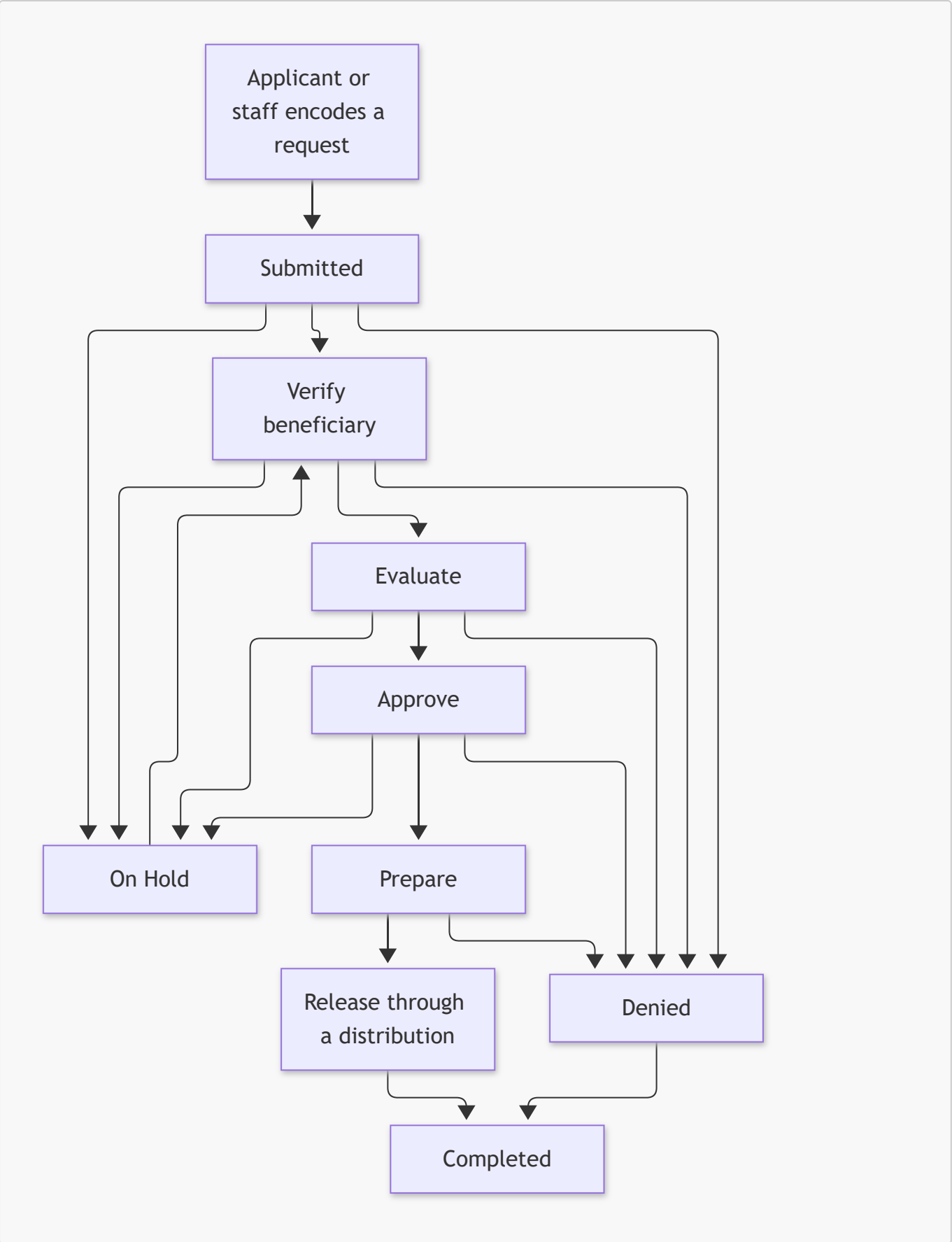
1. **Submitted.** The request is waiting for a first look. Target time: 48 hours.
2. **Verify beneficiary.** Staff check that the person or organization is the right record. Target time: 72 hours.
3. **Evaluate.** Staff check eligibility, documents, and the items asked for. Target time: 72 hours.
4. **Approve.** The request is approved for release. Target time: 48 hours.
5. **Prepare.** Staff get the goods, cash, or service ready. Target time: 48 hours.
6. **Release.** Staff hand the assistance over in a distribution.
7. **Completed.** The request is closed.

From most steps, staff can also:

- put the request **On Hold** while they wait for more information (the clock pauses)
- **Deny** the request (a comment is required)
- **Close** it without a release

A walk-in workflow is shorter: Submitted, then Release, then Completed. The handover is still recorded as a distribution.

Each program uses either the department’s default workflow or a workflow chosen for that program. The buttons on a request are the moves allowed from the current step. CAIS will not mark the request delivered until an individual or batch distribution is complete.



If you are applying

Open **Apply for assistance**. The page lists departments and the programs that are open to the public. A program appears there only when all of these are true:

- staff turned on public intake

- the program is for individuals, not organizations
- the program is still open
- it is a one-off program or a batch, not the parent of a batch series

Fill out the form

1. Choose the program.
2. Enter your name, birthday, sex, mobile number, and address. Mark the boxes that apply: person with disability, 4Ps, solo parent, or indigenous peoples.
3. Choose **Continue**. CAIS looks for a record that already matches your name, birthday, and barangay.
4. If a match appears, confirm that it is you, or choose **None of these, create a new profile**.
5. Enter the quantity you need for each item. Quantity `0` means you are not asking for that item. Answer any extra questions the program asks, and add remarks if you need to.
6. Tick the consent box, then choose **Submit request**.

After you submit, the confirmation screen shows your **CAIS number**. It looks like `PRO-2026-0001`. Write it down. Staff use it to find your request, and you use it to check the status.

Save and come back

Choose **Save for later** if you are not ready to submit. Consent is not required for a draft. The confirmation still shows a CAIS number.

To continue:

1. Open **Track a request**.
2. Enter the CAIS number and your last name.
3. On a saved draft, choose **Continue application**.

Tracking also shows the status of requests you already submitted, the program name, and the date requested. It does not show requests that staff encoded only inside the office.

Kiosk

A shared terminal can open the same form with a kiosk screen. After you submit or save, that screen returns to the program list after a few seconds. Still write down the CAIS number before it leaves.

If you are staff

Sign in with the email and password on your account. If two-factor authentication is on, enter the code from your authenticator app, or a recovery code.

After sign-in, department staff land on the department dashboard. An administrator lands on **Programs**. An executive lands on the executive dashboard.

The sidebar shows the pages your role allows:

Page	What it is for
Dashboard	Counts, charts, and a short program list for your department

Page	What it is for
Programs	The aid programs you encode into, after they are approved
Distributions	Individual releases and batch releases
Queue	Requests assigned to you, and unassigned work for the team
Beneficiaries	People and organizations
Items	Goods, cash, and services, plus stock for goods
Funds	The budgets linked to programs
Notifications	Assignments, due work, returned tasks, and low stock
Admin	Accounts, workflows, and distribution policies. Super admins only

An administrator's sidebar is Programs and Distributions. An executive's sidebar is Dashboard, Programs, and Distributions.

A guided tour is available on the main department pages. It points at the sidebar, filters, and the create buttons.

Your account menu holds profile, security, and appearance.

What each role can do

A person can hold more than one role. The sidebar and the buttons follow those roles. The user manual walks through each job: department head, encoder, verifier, releasing officer, inventory officer, administrator, executive, and super admin.

You only see another department's records if you are a super admin, an administrator, or an executive. Everyone else stays in the department on their account.

Set up a program before requests arrive

Do this once for a new aid run. Later requests reuse the same setup. Staff encode into a program only after it is approved.

1. Add funds

Open **Funds** and add a fund with a name, amount, and year. You will attach it when you create the program.

2. Add items

Open **Items** and add each thing the program can give out.

- **Goods** are physical items. They use a unit such as sack, piece, or kilo, and they are the only kind that tracks stock.
- **Cash** is recorded as an amount in pesos.
- **Service** is recorded as a quantity and unit, with no stock count.

You can classify a goods item with a UNSPSC code so later reports can group what was released.

For goods, open the item's stock drawer:

- **Receipt** adds stock that arrived. You can record a batch number and an expiry date.
- **Allocate** sets aside quantity for a program.
- **Adjust** records stock in or stock out, with a reason.

When on-hand stock for a goods item runs low, CAIS sends a low-stock notification.

3. Create the program

Open **Programs** and choose **Propose New Program**.

Choose one type:

- **One-off program.** Staff encode directly into this program.
- **Program with batches.** The parent holds the name, description, items, questions, document rules, and eligibility. Staff encode only into a batch, such as Batch 1 for January to March. Add the first batch while you create the parent, or add later batches from the parent page. Submit each batch on its own. The parent itself is not submitted.

Then set:

- start and end dates
- whether the program is **Open** or **Closed** (closed programs do not accept new requests)
- funds and items
- extra questions applicants and staff must answer
- a document checklist
- eligibility rules
- the workflow, if this program should not use the department default
- **Distribution**: **Batch distribution** (needs executive approval), **Individual distribution** (a direct release of an already approved request), or **Individual and batch**
- **Organization program**, when the aid is for groups rather than people
- **Enable public intake**, on an individual one-off program or on an individual batch, when residents should apply from the public form

4. Send it for approval

1. Open the draft and choose **Endorse & Forward to Governor**. You can add a remark. The status becomes **Awaiting administrator**.
2. The administrator opens **Programs**, finds it under **Awaiting administrator**, and chooses **Endorse**. The status becomes **Awaiting Governor Approval**. **Return** sends it back to the department.
3. The executive opens **Programs**, finds it under **Awaiting Governor Approval**, and chooses **Approve**. The status becomes **Approved**. **Return to department** sends it back.

If it comes back as **Returned / Shelved**, change it and send it again. After approval, the department can encode requests and start releases.

Copy the public intake link from the program page and share it, or open it on a kiosk.

Beneficiaries

Open **Beneficiaries** to search the registry or add a record.

- An **individual** receives a CAIS number that starts with `PRO`, such as `PRO-2026-0001`.
- An **organization** receives a number that starts with `ORG`.

For a person, record the name, birthday, sex, civil status, address, mobile number, and the same demographic marks used on the public form. You can also store ID numbers.

If PhilSys eVerify is turned on for the office, verify the person before you save. The screen offers face or fingerprint when those methods are configured. If eVerify is off, enter the record by hand.

CAIS warns when a new person looks like someone already in the registry. Confirm the existing record when it is the same person.

Open a beneficiary to see their assistance history.

Record a request in the office

Open an approved, open one-off program or an approved, open batch. A parent program has no encode button.

Choose **Add Assistance** on the assistance list.

1. Search for the beneficiary by CAIS number or name. Create the person or organization first if they are not in the registry.
2. Choose how the request arrived: Letter, Text, Call, Email, Walk In, or Online. Public applications are stored as Online.
3. Enter the requested items and any program questions.
4. Read the eligibility panel before you save.

Eligibility uses the rules on the program, or on the parent when you are encoding into a batch.

Finding	What happens
Wrong demographic type, or the person is not PWD, 4Ps, solo parent, or indigenous when the program requires it	CAIS blocks the request
The person already has an open request in this program or its batches	You can continue only if you enter a reason
The last delivery is still inside the cooldown	You can continue only if you enter a reason
A released quantity would pass the item cap	You can continue only if you enter a reason

The panel also shows earlier assistance for that person, including what was released.

After you save, the request enters the workflow at Submitted, unless the workflow says otherwise. Public drafts stay at Draft / Saved For Later until the applicant submits them.

Work the queue

Open **Queue**.

- **My queue** lists requests assigned to you.
- **Team queue** lists unassigned work waiting for someone with the right role. Turn on include-assigned when you also want to see work that already has an owner.

Filter by program, status, or time state:

Time state	Meaning
On time	Inside the step's target hours
Due soon	Close to the due time
Overdue	Past the due time
Paused	On Hold, so the clock is stopped

Open a row to see the request. If the current task has no assignee and you are allowed to take it, choose **Claim task**. Supervisors with assign permission can assign one request, or several from the team queue, to a staff member.

Work one request

The request page shows the CAIS number, beneficiary, how the request arrived, who encoded it, who it is assigned to, and the current step. A **Distribution** section shows whether a release has started, where it is, and the receipt number once one exists.

Move the workflow

Current task lists the step, the task, the assignee, and the due time. The buttons under it are the allowed moves, such as advance, hold, deny, or close. A deny asks for a comment.

Only the assignee for the current stage can change the status. If you are not the assignee, the page says so.

You can also change the assignee from **Assistance tracking** when you have permission to assign.

Setting the status to Delivered from the request is refused until a distribution is complete. The message is: complete an individual or batch distribution before marking this request delivered.

Attach documents

The document section follows the program checklist. Typical files are a valid ID, an indigency certificate, a delivery photo, a signed acknowledgment, or another file.

Each required document is due either **before Verified** or **before Delivered**. CAIS will not let the request reach that point while a required file is missing. You can still attach extra files that are not on the checklist.

Print the acknowledgment

After a release is recorded, open **Print acknowledgment** on the request, or open the receipt from the venue desk. It prints:

- the CAIS number and beneficiary
- the date requested and the date delivered
- items requested, with requested quantity and released quantity
- items actually released, including additional and substitute lines
- a QR code that opens the request

Other actions on the list

From a program's assistance table you can:

- edit a request that is still open to edits
- copy the CAIS number
- transfer the request to another program in the department
- delete a request, when your role allows it
- update status for several selected rows
- transfer several selected rows
- export the filtered list as CSV or Excel

Release the items

Open **Distributions**. Individual releases go out directly. Batch distributions wait for executive approval. The program's distribution setting decides which of those you can start.

Individual distribution

Choose **Individual distribution** when one person is released at the counter and the request is already approved. Record the release at the venue desk. There is no approval queue for that batch.

Batch distribution

1. Choose **Batch distribution** and build the roster from an approved program.
2. On a draft or returned batch, choose **Validate**, then **Submit for approval**.
3. The administrator endorses the batch. The executive approves the whole batch, or selected beneficiaries, then chooses **Finalize review**. **Return** sends the roster back. A reject closes that submission. **Reopen as draft** is available when the approval policy allows a resubmit.
4. After approval, choose **Schedule** and enter the time and venue.
5. Choose **Start distribution**.
6. Open **Venue desk** and record each release.
7. Choose **Complete** when every approved beneficiary has an outcome.

Cancel batch is available before the batch is in progress. A void or a reprint stays on the release, for an officer who has that permission.

At the venue desk

For each person, record who received the assistance and what was handed over.

- Take a live photo. An officer who can waive the camera enters a reason when the camera cannot be used.
- Save a signature, or tick **Recipient cannot sign** and enter the alternative acknowledgment.

- Choose **Beneficiary** or **Authorized representative**. A representative needs the relationship and how the authorization was checked.
- Confirm identity by control number, request reference, or officer attestation, and tick **I verified this recipient**.
- Enter the quantity or cash amount for each line already on the request. Notes are required for a partial release.
- Choose **Absent** when the person does not collect the assistance.

What happened	What to record
You gave what they asked for	Enter the remaining quantity or amount on that line.
You gave only part of a line	Enter the quantity you handed over and add a note. The outcome can be partial, and the request can be Partially Delivered.
The person did not collect	Choose **Absent**.

Released goods reduce stock. Eligibility caps count released quantities. The acknowledgment lists requested quantity and released quantity, including any additional or substitute lines already on the request.

Read the dashboard

The department dashboard summarizes the period you filter. Use the filters to change the dates and programs behind the numbers.

You will see request and delivery counts, requests by status, items handed over by program, released quantities by UNSPSC classification, top delivered items, demographics, and a short list of programs.

The executive dashboard shows the same kind of totals across departments.

Notifications

Open **Notifications** in the sidebar. The badge is the number still unread.

CAIS notifies you when:

- a request or workflow task is assigned or reassigned to you
- someone claims a task
- a task moves to a new step
- a task is returned
- a task is due
- a request has been sitting too long
- a goods item is low on stock
- an account invite is sent

Open a notification to read it, mark one as read, or mark all as read.

Your account

From the account menu:

- **Profile** updates your name and email. A changed email must be verified.
- **Security** changes your password and turns two-factor authentication on or off. When you enable it, scan the QR code and store the recovery codes.
- **Appearance** switches the theme.

Use **Forgot your password?** on the sign-in page if you cannot get in. You need access to the email on the account.

For super admins

Accounts

Open **Admin**, then **Users**.

Create a user with a name, email, department, and one or more roles. The person receives an invite and sets a password. Leave the department empty for an administrator or an executive who should not work inside one department.

You can update roles and department later, or remove an account.

Workflows

Open **Admin**, then **Workflows**.

A workflow belongs to one department. Create it with a name, code, description, and version, then lay out the steps and the moves between them. Each step has a request status, an optional reason such as Under Review or Ready for Release, a target time in hours, and who should own the task.

When the pipeline is ready:

1. **Publish** it.
2. **Activate** it.
3. Assign it to programs, or leave programs on the department default.

You can duplicate a workflow or start a new version. On a live request you can reassign the current task or override it when the normal buttons are not enough.

New departments start with an active **Standard Assistance Workflow**: Submitted, Verify beneficiary, Evaluate, Approve, Prepare, Release, and Completed, with On Hold and Denied beside that path. A **Walk-in** workflow is the shorter path.

Distribution policies

Open **Distribution policies** to set the approval stages for a batch. The default stages are Administrator endorsement, then Executive approval.

Status words

The request has a main status and a more specific reason.

Status	Reason you may see	Meaning
Draft	Saved For Later	The applicant saved the public form and has not submitted it
Submitted	Awaiting Review	It is in and waiting for staff
Review	Under Review, Pending Documentation, or Verified	Staff are checking the person, the papers, or the request
Approved	Approved or Ready for Release	It may be prepared or released
Delivered	Delivered or Partially Delivered	Some or all of the release is recorded
Denied	Denied or Duplicate	Staff refused it, or it duplicates another request
Closed	Closed	The file is finished
On Hold	Awaiting Information	Staff are waiting, and the time target is paused

While a batch distribution is open, the request can also show one of these reasons:

Reason	Meaning
Distribution draft	The roster is still being built
For distribution validation	The batch is being checked
For distribution approval	The administrator or the executive has not finished
Distribution returned	The roster was sent back to the department
Distribution rejected	That submission was refused
Scheduled for release	A time and venue are set
Release in progress	Staff are recording releases at the venue
Distribution cancelled	The batch was cancelled before it finished
Absent	The person did not collect the assistance

Delivered, Denied, and Closed are finished statuses. A finished request no longer sits in the active queue.

Quick reference

I want to…	Go to…
Apply	Apply for assistance
Check my request	Track a request, with CAIS number and last name
See department totals	Dashboard
Propose a program	Programs, then Propose New Program
Send a program for approval	The program, then Endorse & Forward to Governor

I want to…	Go to…
Endorse a program	Administrator, Programs, Awaiting administrator, Endorse
Approve a program	Executive, Programs, Approve
Add a person	Beneficiaries, then create
Encode a request	An approved program or batch, then Add Assistance
Pick up unassigned work	Queue, Team queue, then Claim task
Release one person at the counter	Distributions, Individual distribution
Release a roster	Distributions, Batch distribution, then Venue desk after Start distribution
Print proof of release	Print acknowledgment on the request, or the receipt at the venue desk
See what is assigned to me	Queue, My queue, or Notifications
Let residents apply online	Program or batch, Enable public intake
Update stock	Items, then the item’s stock drawer